

Gender divide

Cultural conditioning allows women to fly, but only so high

Only **22%** women spend nine or more hours at work, compared to **43%** men. Women also spend less time in school, college and institutes than men do.

63% More women prefer comedy when it comes to movies, while **36%** men married to working women are hooked to action.



HEMANT CHAWLA, Location courtesy: PVR PLAZA, NEW DELHI

The young woman finds solace in her spouse/ boyfriend, who is the best friend for **40%**. Compared to just **33%** men who want to have one or no child, the number is **40%** for women.

Women watch more TV across time slots, except late in the night, when men seem to dominate. **82%** women mostly watch TV with family, **27%** men watch it alone.

82% don't smoke.

Those who do would rather tell friends than family about their smoking habits.

important to the young man as it is to women. Seventy-seven per cent of the men said that given an option, they would want to stay with their parents. Family is something they don't ever sever their ties with. It's their sounding board, their guiding light, even their eventual ambition. It's a place they never lose their affiliation to even in a mobile world. Over 80 per cent of the youth visit their native place or relatives living in another town at least once a year. This is especially true of youth in the north (92 per cent), which according to sociologist Prasanta Ray shows the persistence of a moral community based on kinship and place. "It brings out the resilience of the traditional rearing pattern even when everyday life is seduced by the temptation of freedom," says Ray. Almost 60 per cent have never lived away from home. Even when they have, 43 per cent stayed with the spouse while 18 per cent stayed with relatives.

Major festivals are also family affairs, surely a hang-over of the Sooraj Barjatya school of filmmaking. As many as 42 per cent say that they celebrate Diwali, Christmas or Eid with parents, 35 per cent with their spouse/children, while 29 per cent include siblings in the celebrations. Even secular occasions are family outings. When it comes to taking decisions on careers, the opinions of both parents (39 per cent) matter, understandable given how parents view their children's attainments as possible ways to improve their own social standing.

Family is as much the first port of call in trouble as it is a comfortable emotional cushion, which also shows an inability to make lasting personal communities outside the family. As many as 43 per cent discuss their personal problems with their family (parents/siblings/other relatives), while 26 per cent take their spouse/boyfriend/girlfriend into confidence. Clearly, it's because they regard their parents' marriage as surprisingly perfect. The roots of conservatism, points out sociologist Shiv Visvanathan, run deep. "The umbilical cord is still intact and strong," he says. Indeed, given a choice, 65 per cent (the figure is 70 per cent for 16-24-olds) would like to stay with their parents.

ALL WORK, LITTLE PLAY

Study and work fill up a large part of a young person's life, showing the acceptance of meritocracy. Just over 50 per cent spend five-eight hours in school and college, perhaps because it is a morally approved place for spending quality time with co-eds. One-third of those surveyed say they work for more than nine hours a day, with those outside home working harder than those staying with their family, to compensate for being out of the cocoon.